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COMMUNICATION DEVICE AND METHOD OF BEAM MANAGEMENT

Abstract

A communication device and a method of beam management are provided. The method is adapted to a communication device including an entity and a function, wherein the entity communicates with a network via a first link, and the function forwards signals via a second link, wherein the first link is associated with a first transmission configuration indicator (TCI) state. The method includes: receiving, by the entity, a channel state information (CSI) reporting configuration; transmitting, by the entity, a CSI report according to the CSI reporting configuration; and receiving, by the entity, a TCI state list configuration.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION [0001] The present application is based on, and claims priority from, U.S. provisional Application Ser. No. 63/562,706, filed on Mar. 8, 2024, the disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

Technical Field

[0002] The disclosure is related to a communication device and a method of beam management.

Description of Related Art

[0003] A network-controlled repeater (NCR) may be used for covering the coverage holes between a gNB and a user equipment (UE). Due to limited amplified power of an NCR, operator have to deploy multiple NCRs to cover different areas. However, independent multiple NCRs may introduce issues such as control signal overhead due to multiple NCRs in the same band or limited uplink (UL) scheduling flexibility due to fixed UL power control. For example, UL resources may not be co-scheduled with normal UEs. Therefore, mechanisms for cooperation of multiple NCRs with different operation modes are required.

SUMMARY

[0004] The disclosure is related to a communication device and a method of beam management.

[0005] In one embodiment of the present disclosure, a communication device is provided. The communication device includes an entity and a function, wherein the entity communicates with a network via a first link, and the function forwards signals via a second link, wherein the first link is associated with a first transmission configuration indicator (TCI) state, wherein the entity is configured to perform: receiving a channel state information (CSI) reporting configuration; transmitting a CSI report according to the CSI reporting configuration; and receiving a TCI state list configuration

[0006] In one embodiment of the present disclosure, a method of beam management is provided. The method of beam management is adapted to a communication device comprising an entity and a function, wherein the entity communicates with a network via a first link, and the function forwards signals via a second link, wherein the first link is associated with a first transmission configuration indicator (TCI) state, and the method includes: receiving, by the entity, a channel state information (CSI) reporting configuration; transmitting, by the entity, a CSI report according to the CSI reporting configuration; and receiving, by the entity, a TCI state list configuration.

[0007] In one embodiment of the present disclosure, a communication device is provided. The communication device includes a transceiver and a processor. The processor is coupled to the transceiver, wherein the processor is configured to perform: transmitting a channel state information (CSI) reporting configuration; receiving a CSI report according to the CSI reporting configuration; and transmitting a transmission configuration indicator (TCI) state list configuration.

[0008] In one embodiment of the present disclosure, a method of beam management is provided. The method of beam management is adapted to a communication device, wherein the method includes: transmitting a channel state information (CSI) reporting configuration; receiving a CSI report according to the CSI reporting configuration; and transmitting a transmission configuration indicator (TCI) state list configuration.

[0009] To make the aforementioned more comprehensible, several embodiments accompanied with drawings are described in detail as follows.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0010] The accompanying drawings are included to provide a further understanding of the disclosure, and are incorporated in and constitute a part of this specification. The drawings illustrate exemplary embodiments of the disclosure and, together with the description, serve to explain the principles of the disclosure.

[0011] FIG. 1 illustrates a schematic diagram of a gNB, an NCR, and a UE according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0012] FIG. 2 illustrates a schematic diagram of multiple NCRs according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0013] FIG. 3 illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0014] FIG. 4 illustrates a schematic diagram of beam management for C-link according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0015] FIG. 5 illustrates a schematic diagram of a procedure of beam (or CSI) measurements and beam (or CSI) reporting according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0016] FIG. 6 illustrates a schematic diagram of a procedure of beam maintenance/updating for C-link according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0017] FIG. 7 illustrates a schematic diagram of beam application for BH-link according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0018] FIG. 8 illustrates a schematic diagram of simultaneous DL/UL transmission according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0019] FIG. 9 illustrates a schematic diagram of CORESET and SS according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0020] FIG. 10 illustrates a schematic diagram of independent NCR deployment according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0021] FIG. 11 illustrates a schematic diagram of advance NCR group according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0022] FIG. 12 illustrates a schematic diagram of operation mode A of NCR group according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0023] FIG. 13 illustrates a schematic diagram of operations B and C of NCR group according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0024] FIG. 14 illustrates a schematic diagram of capability reporting of NCR group according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0025] FIG. 15 illustrates a schematic diagram of ambiguity of beam application according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0026] FIG. 16 illustrates a schematic diagram of beam management for C-link through one NCR node according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0027] FIG. 17 illustrates a schematic diagram of determining beam index for C-link by MT according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0028] FIG. 18 illustrates a schematic diagram of reporting restriction with one beam index in a CSI report according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0029] FIG. 19 illustrates a schematic diagram of implicit NCR node reception by NCR priority rule according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0030] FIG. 20 illustrates a schematic diagram of control signaling transmission timeline corresponding to the implicit NCR node reception according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0031] FIG. 21 illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR node reception by indicating an NCR ID

associated with a TCI state according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0032] FIG. **22** illustrates a schematic diagram of sub-lists for each NCR within a TCI state list according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0033] FIG. **23** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on a bitmap according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0034] FIG. **24** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on a bitmap according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0035] FIG. **25** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on list segmentation according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0036] FIG. **26** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on list segmentation according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0037] FIG. **27** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a TCI state with an NCR ID according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0038] FIG. **28** illustrates a schematic diagram of a tagged TCI state list of an NCR according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0039] FIG. **29** illustrates a schematic diagram of beam reporting for each NCR according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0040] FIG. **30** illustrates a schematic diagram of beam reporting with NCR group based CSI compression according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0041] FIG. **31** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR reporting according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0042] FIG. **32** illustrates a schematic diagram of enabling simultaneous reception according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0043] FIG. **33** illustrates a schematic diagram of one beam index associated with limited multiple NCR nodes in a CSI report according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0044] FIG. **34** illustrates a schematic diagram of implicit NCR node reception based on the beam reporting according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0045] FIG. **35** illustrates a schematic diagram of implicit NCR node reception based on the beam reporting according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0046] FIG. **36** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR node reception by indicating NCR IDs associated with a TCI state according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0047] FIG. **37** illustrates a schematic diagram of sub-lists for each NCR within a TCI state list according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0048] FIG. **38** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on a bitmap according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0049] FIG. **39** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on a bitmap according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0050] FIG. **40** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on list segmentation according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0051] FIG. **41** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on list segmentation according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0052] FIG. **42** illustrates a schematic diagram of sub-lists for each NCR within a TCI state list according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0053] FIG. **43** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on a bitmap according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0054] FIG. **44** illustrates a schematic diagram of a TCI state configured with an NCR ID according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0055] FIG. **45** illustrates a schematic diagram of a tagged TCI state list of an NCR according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0056] FIG. **46** illustrates a schematic diagram of enabling simultaneous reception according to one

embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0057] FIG. **47** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR reception based on a time pattern bitmap according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0058] FIG. **48** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR reception based on a time pattern bitmap according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0059] FIG. **49** illustrates a schematic diagram of a time resource configuration according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0060] FIG. **50** illustrates a schematic diagram of determining the association between time pattern and NCR nodes according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0061] FIG. **51** illustrates a schematic diagram of restricted beam reporting according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0062] FIG. **52** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR hopping with common TCI state according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0063] FIG. **53** illustrates a schematic diagram of implicit NCR node reception according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0064] FIG. **54** illustrates a schematic diagram of indicating NCR IDs associated with a TCI state according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0065] FIG. **55** illustrates a schematic diagram of sub-lists for each NCR within a TCI state list according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0066] FIG. **56** illustrates a schematic diagram of sub-lists for each NCR within a TCI state list according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0067] FIG. **57** illustrates a schematic diagram of a TCI state configured with an NCR ID according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0068] FIG. **58** illustrates a schematic diagram of a tagged TCI state list of an NCR according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0069] FIG. **59** illustrates a schematic diagram of determining the association between time pattern and NCR nodes according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0070] FIG. **60** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR hopping with multiple TCI states according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0071] FIG. **61** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR hopping with multiple TCI states according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0072] FIG. **62** illustrates a schematic diagram of SS set monitoring according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0073] FIG. **63** illustrates a schematic diagram of SS set monitoring according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0074] FIG. **64** illustrates a schematic diagram of CORESET group monitoring according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0075] FIG. **65** illustrates a schematic diagram of capability of NCR according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0076] FIG. **66** illustrates a schematic diagram of operation mode switching according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0077] FIG. **67** illustrates a schematic diagram of operation mode switching according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0078] FIG. **68** illustrates a schematic diagram of a scheme of restricted beam reporting for NCR-MT with Capability 1 according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0079] FIG. **69** illustrates a schematic diagram of a scheme of restricted beam reporting for NCR-MT with Capability 3 according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0080] FIG. **70** illustrates a schematic diagram of a scheme of restricted beam reporting for NCR-MT with Capability 2 according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0081] FIG. **71** illustrates a schematic diagram of a scheme of implicit NCR node reception for

NCR-MT with Capability 1 according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0082] FIG. **72** illustrates a schematic diagram of a scheme of implicit NCR node reception for NCR-MT with Capability 3 according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0083] FIG. **73** illustrates a schematic diagram of a scheme of implicit NCR node reception for NCR-MT with Capability 2 according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0084] FIG. **74** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR node reception based on NCR ID for NCR-MT with Capability 1 according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0085] FIG. **75** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR node reception based on NCR ID for NCR-MT with Capability 3 according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0086] FIG. **76** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR node reception based on NCR ID for NCR-MT with Capability 2 according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0087] FIG. **77** illustrates a schematic diagram of time resource configurations according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0088] FIG. **78** illustrates a flowchart of a method of beam management according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0089] FIG. **79** illustrates a flowchart of a method of beam management according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0090] FIG. **80** illustrates a schematic diagram of a communication device according to one embodiment of the present disclosure.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

[0091] The acronyms in the present disclosure are defined as follows:

TABLE-US-00001 Acronym Full Name
AL Aggregation level
CC component carrier
CRI CSI-RS resource indicator
CSI Channel state information
CSI-RS Channel state information reference signal
CSS Common search space
CORESET Control Resource Set
DCI downlink control information
DL downlink
DM-RS Demodulation RS
gNodeB (gNB) next Generation Node B
ID identity
L1 layer 1
MAC medium access control
MAC CE MAC control element
MSG message
NCR Network-controlled Repeater
OM operation mode
PDCCH Physical downlink control channel
PDSCH Physical downlink shared channel
PUCCH physical uplink control channel
PUSCH physical uplink share channel
QCL quasi co-located
RF Radio frequency
RRC radio resource control
RS reference signal
RSRP Reference signal receiving power
RSRQ Reference signal receiving quality
Rx received beam
SINR signal to interference noise ratio
SRI SRS resource indicator
SRS Sounding reference signal
SS search space
SSB Synchronization signal block
SSBRI SSB resource indicator
TCI Transmission configuration indicator
TRP transmission reception point
Tx transmitted beam
TXRU transceiver unit
UE user equipment
UL uplink
USS UE-specific search space
UCI Uplink control information

[0092] A cell may be a serving cell, a carrier or a CC (component carrier), a serving cell, MCG (master cell group), or SCG (second cell group), but not limited herein.

[0093] “Configured” may indicate default, predefined, fixed, configured, activated, or indicated, but not limited herein.

[0094] RRC may be MAC CE or DCI, but not limited herein.

[0095] UL transmission may be PUSCH, PUCCH, physical random access channel (PRACH), SRS, or RS, but not limited herein.

[0096] NCR may be an NCR group, UE, TRP, gNB, or panel, but not limited herein.

[0097] RS may be DL RS and/or UL RS.

[0098] A DL RS configuration may be a DM-RS group, a DM-RS group index, a DM-RS resource, a DM-RS resource index, a DM-RS port index, a DM-RS port, a CSI-RS resource set index, a CSI-RS resource set, a CSI-RS resource index, a CSI-RS resource, a CSI-RS port index, a CSI-RS port, a SSB resource set index, a SSB resource set, a SSB resource index, a SSB resource, a SSB port index, or a SSB port, but not limited herein.

[0099] A UL RS configuration may be a DM-RS group, a DM-RS group index, a DM-RS resource,

a DM-RS resource index, a DM-RS port index, a DM-RS port, a random access channel (RACH) group, a RACH group index, a RACH resource, a RACH resource index, a SRS resource set index, a SRS resource set, a SRS resource index, a SRS resource, a SRS port index, or a SRS port, but not limited herein.

[0100] A beam may be represented by an antenna, an antenna port, an antenna element, a group of antenna, a group of antenna port, a group of antenna element, a spatial domain filter, a reference signal resource, a QCL assumption, or a TXRU, but not limited herein. For example, a first beam may be represented as a first antenna port or a first group of antenna port or a first spatial domain filter. For example, a first beam direction may be represented as a QCL assumption or a spatial domain filter.

[0101] A Rx beam in configuration may be a spatial Rx parameter, a spatial domain receive filter, or a panel, but not limited herein.

[0102] A Tx beam in configuration may be a spatial Tx parameter, a spatial domain transmission filter, or a panel, but not limited herein.

[0103] An index or an identity may be CORESETPoolIndex, TRP ID, or Panel ID, but not limited herein.

[0104] A Cell TRP (e.g., transmission reception point) may be a TRP, a serving cell, a gNodeB (i.e., next Generation Node B), a panel, an unlicensed cell, an unlicensed serving cell, an unlicensed TRP, a gNodeB, an eNodeB (i.e., evolved NodeB), or an eNB, but not limited herein.

[0105] Communication device may be represented by UE or gNodeB, but not limited herein.

[0106] Combinations of embodiments disclosed is not precluded.

[0107] All steps in the embodiment may not be performed in a step-by-step way.

[0108] Embodiments disclosed may apply for unlicensed band, licensed band, non-DRX mode, DRX mode, or power saving, but not limited herein.

[0109] An NCR-MT may receive one or more CSI reports from each NCR node within the same NCR group, and the NCR-MT may generate a new CSI report (or an updated CSI report) based on the CSI reports received from each NCR node and may transmit the new CSI report to the gNB.

[0110] An NCR may be configured to cover the coverage holes between a gNB and a UE, as shown in FIG. 1. Signals between the gNB and the UE may be forwarded to each other through the NCR **10**. Due to limited amplified power of an NCR, operator may deploy multiple NCRs to cover different areas. For example, operator may deploy NCR **21**, NCR **22**, and NCR **23** to cover different areas, as shown in FIG. 2.

[0111] FIG. 3 illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR **30** according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. The NCR **30** may include an NCR-mobile terminal (NCR-MT) entity **31** and an NCR-forwarding (NCR-Fwd) entity **32**. The NCR-MT entity **31** is a function entity to communicate with a gNB (or network) via a control link (C-link) to enable exchange of control information, wherein the C-link may be associated with a TCI state. The NCR-Fwd entity **32** is a function entity to perform the amplify-and-forwarding of UL/DL RS signal between a gNB (or network) and a UE via a backhaul link (BH-link) and an access link (AC-link). For example, the NCR-Fwd entity **32** may communicate with the gNB via the BH-link and may communicate with the UE via the AC-link.

[0112] In one example, NCR may be a communication device, a reconfigurable intelligent surface (RIS), a reflect device, a relay, a remote radio head (RRH), a Network element, a Base station (BS), a transmission reception point (TRP), a smart repeater, or a gNB, but not limited herein.

[0113] In one example, an NCR may be a RIS.

[0114] In one example, an NCR may comprise a RIS.

[0115] In one example, the NCR-Fwd may be a RIS.

[0116] In one example, the NCR-Fwd may comprise a RIS.

[0117] In one example, an NCR may comprise an NCR-MT entity and/or an NCR-Fwd entity.

[0118] In one example, an NCR-MT may be activated or de-activated in an NCR.

[0119] In one example, an NCR-MT may be not included in an NCR.

[0120] In one example, a first NCR may comprise a MT entity (e.g., NCR-MT entity).

[0121] In one example, a second NCR may comprise a Fwd entity (e.g., NCR-Fwd entity).

[0122] An NCR may include an NCR-MT entity and an NCR-Fwd entity.

[0123] Throughout this document, statements using the term “UE” may be equally applicable to the NCR-MT entity. Statements using the term “NCR” may be equally applicable to the NCR-Fwd entity.

[0124] A procedure for the NCR-MT to perform cell search, system information acquisition, random access procedure, UCI reporting, or PDCCH monitoring is same as a corresponding procedure for a UE.

[0125] A procedure for the NCR-MT to perform PDSCH reception, CSI-RS measurements and CSI determination, PUSCH transmission, or SRS transmission may be same as a corresponding procedure for a UE.

[0126] The NCR-Fwd may transmit or may receive only after the NCR-MT receives on the control link an indication for one or more beams for the NCR-Fwd to use for transmissions or receptions over corresponding one or more time resources on the access link. When the NCR-MT performs a link recovery procedure, the NCR-Fwd may not transmit or receive until the link recovery procedure is complete.

[0127] FIG. 4 illustrates a schematic diagram of beam management for C-link according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. The procedure of beam management for C-link may include the step of beam (or CSI) measurement and reporting, the step of beam maintenance/updating, and the step of beam application for BH-link, wherein each step may be executed independently. In the step of beam measurement and reporting, the gNB may receive CSI report from the NCR 40, wherein the CSI report may include measurement values (e.g., SSBRI or RSRP) corresponding to the RS (e.g., RS #n or RS #n+1) transmitted from the gNB to the NCR 40. In the step of beam maintenance/updating, the NCR 40 may receive TCI state list configuration which may be configured with a TCI state list by the gNB, wherein the TCI state list may include mapping relationships between TCI state ID (e.g., A.sub.n) and spatial QCL assumption (e.g., spatial QCL assumption corresponding to RS #n). In step of beam application for BH-link, the NCR 40 may perform or may not perform simultaneous transmissions with the gNB.

[0128] FIG. 5 illustrates a schematic diagram of a procedure of beam (or CSI) measurements and beam (or CSI) reporting according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. In step S51, the NCR may receive RS configuration (or CSI reporting configuration) from the gNB and may be configured with one or more RS (e.g., CSI-RS or SSB, such as RS #1-RS #5) for beam measurements. The NCR may be configured with a quantity for beam reporting, wherein the quantity may include a beam index (e.g., SSBRI/CRI) or a beam quality (e.g., L1-RSRP or L1-SINR). The RS configuration (or CSI reporting configuration) may include a reference signal list, a number of NCR, or a number of reporting RS for each NCR in the CSI report. In step S52, the NCR may perform beam measurement according to the RS configuration (or CSI reporting configuration). The NCR may generate a measurement result accordingly. In step S53, the NCR may report the measurement result (e.g., via a CSI report) to the gNB according to the RS configuration (or CSI reporting configuration), wherein the measurement result may include one or more beam indexes and/or measurement qualities. The CSI report may include IDs of one or more reference signals, RSRP values corresponding to one or more reference signals, or signal to noise ratio (SNR) values of one or more reference signals.

[0129] FIG. 6 illustrates a schematic diagram of a procedure of beam maintenance/updating for C-link according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. The NCR 60 may receive a TCI state list configuration. The NCR 60 may be configured with a TCI state list within the higher layer parameter (e.g., maxNumberConfiguredTCIStatesPerCC), wherein the TCI state list may include up to N TCI-state configurations, wherein N is a positive integer and N may be dependent on the

capability of the NCR **60**. Each TCI-state may contain parameters for configuring a quasi co-location relationship between one or more DL reference signals and the DM-RS ports of the PDSCH, the DM-RS ports of the PDCCH, or the CSI-RS ports of a CSI-RS resource. For example, the TCI state list may include N TCI-state configurations, wherein each TCI-state configuration may include a relationship between a TCI state ID (e.g., A.sub.1, A.sub.2, . . . , or A.sub.N) and a corresponding reference signal (e.g., RS #1 corresponding to A.sub.1, RS #2 corresponding to A.sub.2, . . . , or RS #N corresponding to A.sub.N).

[0130] FIG. 7 illustrates a schematic diagram of beam application for BH-link according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. The NCR **70** may be configured with a TCI state list (e.g., TCI state list **71**) of beams for C-link through an RRC message from the gNB. The NCR **70** may select only one beam (e.g., select one TCI state ID) from the TCI state list for BH-link according to a MAC CE (e.g., MAC CE **72**) received by the NCR **70**.

[0131] FIG. 8 illustrates a schematic diagram of simultaneous DL/UL transmission according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. If the NCR **80** does not support simultaneous transmission on the C-link and the BH-link (e.g., NCR **80** does not perform transmissions/receptions on the C-link and the BH-link simultaneously in the same set of symbols), the NCR-Fwd of the NCR **80** may not perform a transmission over a time resource if the NCR-MT of the NCR **80** performs a transmission over the time resource. For example, the C-link may be implemented by RS #n+2 while the BH-link is implemented by RS #n, wherein RS #n and RS #n+2 are different reference signals. When the NCR **80** does support simultaneous transmission on the C-link and the BH-link, the NCR **80** may simultaneously transmit or receive signal via both the C-link and the BH-link in a set of symbols. For example, both the C-link and the BH-link may be implemented by RS #n+2.

[0132] When the NCR **80** simultaneously receives signals via both the C-link and the BH-link in a set of symbols, the TCI state for receptions on the BH-link may be the same as the TCI state for receptions on the C-link in the set of symbols. That is, NCR **80** may perform receptions via the BH-link according to a quasi co-location relationship, wherein the quasi co-location relationship may be determined according to a TCI state indicated to NCR **80**. The TCI state may be included in a DL beam indication in an MCA CE. In other words, NCR **80** may perform receptions via the C-link and the BH-link simultaneously in a set of symbols, wherein the TCI state for receptions via the BH-link may be the same as the TCI state for receptions via the C-link.

[0133] When the NCR **80** simultaneously transmits signals via both the C-link and the BH-link in a set of symbols, the spatial filter of the NCR **80** for transmission on the BH-link may be the same as the spatial filter of the NCR **80** for transmission on the C-link in the set of symbols. That is, NCR **80** may perform transmissions via both the C-link and the BH-link simultaneously in a set of symbols, wherein the spatial filter used by NCR **80** for the transmissions via the C-link may be the same as the spatial filter used by NCR **80** for the transmissions via the BH-link.

[0134] Assume that the NCR **80** does not simultaneously receive signals on the C-link and the BH-link. That is, a set of symbols received by the NCR **80** from the C-link may be different from a set of symbols received by the NCR **80** from the BH-link. If the NCR **80** does not support determination of a TCI state for receptions on the BH-link based on an indication of a TCI state from the serving cell, or if the NCR **80** does not receive an indication of a TCI state for receptions on the BH-link (e.g., if the NCR **80** does not receive an indication of a unified TCI state for receptions by the NCR-MT), receptions on the BH-link may use the QCL parameters same as the QCL parameters for PDCCH receptions in a CORESET with the lowest controlResourceSetId in the active DL bandwidth part (BWP).

[0135] In one embodiment, an NCR (or NCR-MT) may obtain an indication of a TCI state for receptions on BH-link from a TCI state list configuration received from the gNB.

[0136] If the NCR **80** does not support determination of a TCI state for receptions on the BH-link based on an indication of a TCI state from the serving cell, but the NCR **80** does receive an

indication of a unified TCI state for receptions by the NCR-MT, the receptions on the BH-link may use the QCL parameters (e.g., a quasi co-location relationship) provided by an indicated unified TCI state for receptions by the NCR-MT.

[0137] If the NCR **80** does support determination of a TCI state for receptions on the BH-link based on an indication of a TCI state from the serving cell, and the NCR **80** does receive an indication of a TCI state for receptions on the BH-link, the receptions on the BH-link may use the QCL parameters provided by a TCI state in the NCR DL BH-link beam indication MAC CE.

[0138] Assume that the NCR **80** does not simultaneously transmit signals on the C-link and the BH-link. That is, a set of symbols received by the NCR **80** from the C-link may be different from a set of symbols received by the NCR **80** from the BH-link. If the NCR **80** does not support determination of a spatial filter for transmissions on the BH-link based on an indication of a unified TCI state or an SRI from the serving cell, or if the NCR-MT does not receive an indication of a unified TCI state or an SRI for determining a spatial filter for transmission on the BH-link (e.g., if the NCR **80** does not receive an indication of a unified TCI state for transmissions by the NCR-MT), the transmissions on the BH-link may use the spatial filter same as the spatial filter associated with the PUCCH resource with the smallest pucch-ResourceId in PUCCH-ResourceSet in the active UL BWP.

[0139] If the NCR **80** does not support determination of a spatial filter for transmission on the BH-link based on an indication of a unified TCI state or an SRI from the serving cell, but the NCR **80** does receive an indication of a unified TCI state for transmission by the NCR-MT, the transmissions on the BH-link may use the spatial filter corresponding to the indicated unified TCI state for transmission by the NCR-MT.

[0140] If the NCR **80** does not support determination of a spatial filter for transmission on the BH-link based on an indication of a unified TCI state or an SRI from the serving cell, and the NCR **80** does receive an indication of a unified TCI state or an SRI for determining a spatial filter for transmissions on the BH-link, the transmissions on the BH-link may use the spatial filter corresponding to a unified TCI state or an SRI provided in NCR UL BH-link beam indication MAC CE.

[0141] In one embodiment, the NCR-Fwd of the NCR **80** may use the same beam for transmission and receptions on the access link during respective time resources, wherein the respective time resources may be associated with the same beam index.

[0142] The NCR **80** or the gNB may support the semi-static beam indication for BH-link. If the unified TCI framework is not used for NCR-MT, the DL beam may be indicated by MAC CE to select one of TCI state IDs from the RRC-configured list of beams for C-link, or the UL beam may be indicated by an SRI on C-link, wherein the SRI may be included in a MAC CE. If the unified TCI framework is used for NCR-MT, the DL or UL beam may be indicated by a MAC CE to select one of TCI state IDs from the RRC-configured list of beams for C-link.

[0143] FIG. **9** illustrates a schematic diagram of CORESET and SS according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. The NCR **90** may monitor SS set for PDCCH according to the activated TCI state associated with the corresponding CORESET. The SS set may be associated with a CORESET, and the CORESET may be activated with one TCI state. One or more time resources (e.g., the 1st time resource or the 2nd time resource in the following embodiments) may be indicated by the CORESET.

[0144] FIG. **10** illustrates a schematic diagram of independent NCR deployment according to one embodiment of the present disclosure, and FIG. **11** illustrates a schematic diagram of advance NCR group according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. In FIG. **10**, NCR **101** and NCR **102** are deployed independently. MT #1 of the NCR **101** may communicate with the gNB via C-link C1. Fwd #1 of the NCR **101** may communicate with the gNB via BH-link BH1. MT #2 of the NCR **102** may communicate with the gNB via C-link C2. Fwd #2 of the NCR **102** may communicate with the gNB via BH-link BH2. The issues of independent NCR deployment may include: control

signal overhead due to multiple NCR nodes in the same band; and limited UL scheduling flexibility due to fixed UL power control.

[0145] To increase the efficiency and flexibility for cooperation of multiple NCRs, the present disclosure proposes an advanced NCR group scheme. An NCR group may include at least one NCR-MT to communicate with gNB through at least one NCR node. For example, the lines connecting NCR **101**, NCR **102**, and MT **103** represent that MT **103** may be communicatively connected to NCR **101** or NCR **102** via wireline or wireless channel, and MT **103** may be shared between NCR **101** and NCR **102**. When MT **103** want to communicate with the gNB, MT **103** may communicate with the gNB via the C-link C between NCR **101** and the gNB. For an NCR group (e.g., group of NCR **101** and NCR **102**), the number of NCR-MTs used to communicate with the gNB can be reduced. As a result, control signaling overhead may be decreased, UL resource scheduling (e.g., co-scheduled with normal UEs) may become more flexible, power consumption for C-link operations may be reduced, and greater flexibility in BH-link operations (e.g., the BH-link is not required to cooperate with the C-link) may be achieved.

[0146] The characteristic of the proposed NCR group may include: multiple NCRs within the NCR group may communicate with a network via one (or more than one) NCR-MT; each NCR in the NCR group may have one NCR-Fwd; or one NCR-MT may be activated to control the behavior of the NCR-Fwds among multi-NCRs.

[0147] FIG. **12** illustrates a schematic diagram of operation mode A of NCR group according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. **13** illustrates a schematic diagram of operations B and C of NCR group according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. The NCR group may include, for example, NCR **111**, NCR **112**, and NCR **113**. When operation mode A is applied, the NCR group may access the C-link through one NCR node to communicate with gNB. For example, the NCR group may access the C-link C through NCR **111** to communicate with gNB, wherein the NCR-Fwds of NCR **111**, NCR **112**, and NCR **113** may access BH-link BH1, BH-link BH2, and BH-link BH3 respectively to communicate with gNB, as shown in FIG. **12**.

[0148] Compared to operation mode A, operation mode B or operation mode C may improve the reliability, diversity gain, and robustness of the communication system. When operation mode B is applied, the NCR group may access the C-link through more than one NCR node (e.g., through NCR **111** and NCR **112**) simultaneously, as shown in control signaling transmission timeline **131** in FIG. **13**. When operation mode C is applied, the NCR group may access the C-link through more than one NCR node (e.g., through NCR **111** and NCR **112**) by time-division multiplexing (TDM), as shown in data transmission time line **132** in FIG. **13**.

[0149] FIG. **14** illustrates a schematic diagram of capability reporting of NCR group **140** according to one embodiment of the present disclosure, wherein NCR group **140** may include NCR #1, NCR #2, and NCR #3, and a MT may be shared among NCR #1, NCR #2, and NCR #3. In step **S141**, the NCR group **140** may transmit a random-access channel (RACH) preamble to the gNB through MSG1. In step **S142**, the gNB may transmit a random-access response (RAR) to the NCR group **140** through MSG2 in response to the RACH preamble. In step **S143**, the NCR group **140** may transmit an RRC setup request to the gNB through MSG3 in response to the RAR. In step **S144**, the gNB may transmit an RRC setup message to the NCR group **140** through MSG4 in response to the RRC setup request. In step **S145**, the NCR group **140** may transmit an RRC setup complete message to the gNB through MSG5 in response to the RRC setup message. The NCR group **140** (or the NCR-MT) may report the capability (or the repeater related information) of the NCR group to the gNB through the RRC setup complete message, wherein the capability may include: NCR with advanced functionalities (e.g., NCR grouping); the number of NCRs within the NCR group (e.g., the number of NCRs associated with each other); or the corresponding NCR ID of the NCR group (or NCR IDs of NCRs among the NCR group).

[0150] FIG. **15** illustrates a schematic diagram of ambiguity of beam application according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. If multiple NCRs communicate with the gNB using a C-link

through a single NCR node (as shown in FIG. 12), ambiguity in beam application may occur. The same beam indexes (e.g., SSBRI) corresponding to different NCRs may be included in the CSI report. If the beam index is applied to a channel/RS, it is not clear which NCR should receive the channel/RS or handle the C-link in the beam application stage. For example, if NCR 151 and NCR 152 report the same beam index (e.g., SSBRI of RS #n) to the gNB and the beam index is applied to a channel/RS, the gNB would not know which NCR (e.g., NCR 151 or 152) should handle the C-link so as to receive the channel/RS.

[0151] FIG. 16 illustrates a schematic diagram of beam management for C-link through one NCR node according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. It is assumed that both NCR 161 and NCR 162 report the same beam index (i.e., the beam index corresponding to RS #n) to the gNB, NCR 161 may apply BH-link #1 using RS #n+1, and NCR 162 may apply BH-link #2 using RS #n+2, wherein RS #n could be received by both NCR 161 and NCR 162 for C-link. If the C-link is applied through NCR 161, BH-link #1's beam may follow C-link's beam. That is, NCR 161 may perform data transmission on both the C-link and BH-link #1 simultaneously using RS #n. NCR 161 may not use RS #n+1 for BH-link #1. On the other hand, if the C-link is applied through NCR 162, BH-link #2's beam may follow C-link's beam. That is, NCR 162 may perform data transmission on both the C-link and BH-link #2 simultaneously using RS #n. NCR 162 may not use RS #n+2 for BH-link #2.

[0152] FIG. 17 illustrates a schematic diagram of determining beam index for C-link by MT according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. MT may determine/report an NCR ID for C-link in a new field of the CSI report, wherein the NCR ID may indicate the NCR for applying the C-link. For example, if the best beams respectively measured by NCR 171 and NCR 172 are the same (e.g., RS #n), the MT may report an NCR ID to the gNB through the CSI report, wherein the NCR ID may indicate one of NCR 171 and NCR 172 for applying the C-link using RS #n. In one embodiment, a fixed/pre-determined/configured value in a new field of the CSI report may indicate no NCR ID recommendation.

[0153] FIG. 18 illustrates a schematic diagram of reporting restriction with one beam index in a CSI report according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. In one embodiment, one beam index may be associated with one NCR in a CSI report. If the beam indexes reported by different NCRs are the same, only the beam index with the highest beam quality may be reported. For example, assume that NCR 181 and NCR 182 report the same beam index RS #n. If a first RSRP of RS #n measured by NCR 181 is greater or equal to a second RSRP of RS #n measured by NCR 182, the MT may report a CSI report indicating that the beam index (e.g., SSBRI) of RS #n is associated with NCR 181. If a first RSRP of RS #n measured by NCR 181 is less than a second RSRP of RS #n measured by NCR 182, the MT may report a CSI report indicating that the beam index of RS #n is associated with NCR 182.

[0154] A UE (e.g., NCR-MT) may not expect the configured number of RSs for CSI report is less than the number of NCRs in the NCR group. If the configured number of RSs for CSI report is less than the number of NCRs in the NCR group, the CSI report may include a null information, wherein the null information may indicate that an NCR may not select a corresponding beam index. The null information may include the highest CRI/SSBRI value, the lowest CRI/SSBRI value, or the lowest RSRP/SINR value.

[0155] FIG. 19 illustrates a schematic diagram of implicit NCR node reception by NCR priority rule according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. If the same indexes corresponding to different NCRs are included in a CSI report, the channel/RS corresponding to the beam index may be received by an NCR with a predetermined rule. For example, the channel/RS may be received by the NCR with the lowest NCR ID, the highest NCR ID or the highest CSI quality among the multiple NCRs. For example, assume that the NCR ID of NCR 191 is NCR #1 and the NCR ID of NCR 192 is NCR #2. If NCR 191 and NCR 192 report the same beam index (e.g., RS #n), NCR 191 with the lowest NCR ID (e.g., NCR #1) may handle the C-link.

[0156] FIG. **20** illustrates a schematic diagram of control signaling transmission timeline corresponding to the implicit NCR node reception according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. The NCR-MT may be configured with an application time for determining an NCR (e.g., the NCR with the lowest NCR ID, the highest NCR ID, or the highest CSI quality) from multiple NCRs according to the predetermined rule. The application time may start from the least symbols of the CSI report in PUCCH/PUSCH (e.g., the application time may start from the time point T0 and stop at the time point T1). After the application time, the determined NCR may be used for the latest CSI report.

[0157] FIG. **21** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR node reception by indicating an NCR ID associated with a TCI state according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. A CORESET may be activated with a TCI state or a CORESET may be associated with an NCR, wherein the SS set monitoring associated with the CORESET may be received by the NCR with the activated TCI state. For example, if CORESET configuration **210** received by the NCR-MT includes a CORESET ID, an NCR ID of NCR #1, and a TCI state ID corresponding to RS #n, the SS set monitoring associated with the CORESET ID may be received by NCR #1 with an activated TCI state corresponding to the TCI state ID (or RS #n). A DL channel may be received by NCR #1 according to the NCR ID.

[0158] FIG. **22** illustrates a schematic diagram of sub-lists for each NCR within a TCI state list according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. One TCI state list may include one or more sub-lists associated with one or more NCRs respectively. The number of configured TCI states associated with each NCR or the total number of configured TCI states within the TCI state list may be indicated by the TCI state list, wherein the number of configured TCI states associated with one specific NCR may be less than or equal to the total number of configured TCI states within the TCI state list. For example, the TCI state list **220** may include a sub-list for NCR #1, a sub-list for NCR #2, and a sub-list for NCR #3. The sub-list for NCR #1 may include information associated with TCI state IDs A.sub.1, A.sub.2, . . . , A.sub.n, and may indicate that the number of the configured TCI states for NCR #1 is “n”, wherein “n” is a positive integer. The sub-list for NCR #2 may include information associated with TCS state IDs B.sub.1, B.sub.2, . . . , B.sub.m, and may indicate that the number of the configured TCI states for NCR #2 is “m”, wherein “m” is a positive integer. The sub-list for NCR #3 may include information associated with TCI state IDs C.sub.1, C.sub.2, . . . , C.sub.k, and may indicate that the number of the configured TCI states for NCR #3 is “k”, wherein “k” is a positive integer. It should be noted that $n+m+k \leq$ the maximum number of configured TCI states within the TCI state list **220**.

[0159] FIG. **23** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on a bitmap according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with a TCI state list and one or more bit streams corresponding to different NCRs respectively. The size of the TCI state list may be determined according to the parameter `maxNumberConfiguredTCIstates`. The size of the bit streams may be equal to the size of the TCI state list, wherein the m-th bit stream may be associated with the m-th NCR, and the n-th configured TCI state of the TCI state list may be corresponded to the n-th bit of the bit stream. If the n-th bit of the m-th bit stream is set to “1”, the corresponding n-th configured TCI state may be associated with the m-th NCR. If the n-th bit of the m-th bit stream is set to “0”, the corresponding n-th configured TCI state may not be associated with the m-th NCR. For example, if a bit corresponding to the TCI state A.sub.1 of the bit stream **231** is set to “1”, the NCR may determine that the TCI state A.sub.1 is associated with NCR #1. If a bit corresponding to the TCI state B.sub.1 of the bit stream **232** is set to “1”, the NCR may determine that the TCI state B.sub.1 is associated with NCR #2. If a bit corresponding to the TCI state C.sub.1 of the bit stream **233** is set to “1”, the NCR may determine that the TCI state C.sub.1 is associated with NCR #3.

[0160] FIG. **24** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on a bitmap according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured

with a TCI state list and at least one bit stream. The size of the TCI state list may be determined according to the parameter `maxNumberConfiguredTCIstates`. The size of the bits stream may be equal to the size of the TCI state list. The n -th configured TCI state of the TCI state list may be corresponded to the n -bit of the bit stream. If the n -th bit of the bit stream is set to “1”, the corresponding n -th configured TCI state may be associated with a first NCR ID (e.g., NCR #1). If the n -th bit of the bit stream is set to “0”, the corresponding n -th configured TCI state may be associated with a second NCR ID (e.g., NCR #2). For example, since the first bit of the bit stream **240** is set to “1”, the NCR-MT may determine that the TCI state A.sub.1 corresponding to the first bit is associated with NCR #1. Since the second bit of the bit stream **240** is set to “0”, the NCR-MT may determine that the TCI state B.sub.1 corresponding to the second bit is associated with NCR #2.

[0161] FIG. **25** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on list segmentation according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with a TCI state list or a list of size for one or more NCRs. The multiple sizes in the list of size may respectively correspond to multiple NCRs (or multiple NCR IDs) in a list of NCR. For example, assume that the size of a TCI state list is $N+M$, where N and M are positive integers. If a list of size is configured to the NCR, and the list of size indicates that the size of TCI state list (or sub-list) of NCR #1 is equal to N , the NCR-MT may determine that the first N bits of the bit streams **250** of the TCI state list are associated with NCR #1, and the remaining M bits of the bit streams **250** are associated with NCR #2.

[0162] FIG. **26** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on list segmentation according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with a TCI state list, a size of TCI state list for one or more NCRs, or a starting position for the one or more NCRs. For example, if the size of TCI state list for NCR #1 is equal to N and the starting position for NCR #1 is the first bit, the NCR-MT may determine that N bits of the bit stream **260** of the TCI state list are associated with NCR #1, wherein the starting position of the N bits is the first bit of the bit stream **260**. If the size of TCI state list for NCR #2 is equal to M and the starting position for NCR #2 is the $(N+1)$ -th bit, the NCR-MT may determine that M bits of the bit stream **260** are associated with NCR #2, wherein the starting position of the M bits is the $(N+1)$ -th bit of the bit stream **260**.

[0163] FIG. **27** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a TCI state with an NCR ID according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more TCI state configurations, wherein each TCI state configuration may include a mapping relationship among a TCI state ID, a spatial QCL assumption, and an NCR ID. The NCR-MT may receive the downlink channel according to the NCR ID. For example, if the TCI state list **270** configured to the NCR-MT include a TCI state configuration corresponding to the TCI state ID A.sub. n and the ID NCR1, the NCR-MT may receive the PDCCH through a NCR corresponding to the ID NCR1 with an activate TCI state corresponding to the TCI state ID A.sub. n .

[0164] FIG. **28** illustrates a schematic diagram of a tagged TCI state list of an NCR according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more TCI state lists, wherein each TCI state list may be associated with an NCR or may be configured with an NCR. The CORESET may be activated with a TCI state. The CORESET may be associated with a TCI state list ID, wherein the SS set monitoring associated with the CORESET may be received by the corresponding NCR with the activated TCI state. For example, the NCR-MT may be configured with a TCI state list **281** tagged with ID NCR #1 or a TCI state list **282** tagged with ID NCR #2. The CORESET may indicate that the control resources should be applied by the NCR corresponding to the TCI state list ID with the activated TCI state A.sub. n .

[0165] FIG. **29** illustrates a schematic diagram of beam reporting for each NCR according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with the number of reporting beams for each NCR. For example, two reporting beams for each NCR may be included

in one CSI report. Assume that an NCR group includes NCR #1, NCR #2, NCR #3, and NCR #4. 1.sup.st CRI or SSBRI and 2.sup.nd CRI or SSBRI for NCR #1, 3.sup.rd CRI or SSBRI and 4.sup.th CRI or SSBRI for NCR #2, 5.sup.th CRI or SSBRI and 6.sup.th CRI or SSBRI for NCR #3, and 7.sup.th CRI or SSBRI and 8.sup.th CRI or SSBRI for NCR #4 may be included in the CSI report **290**.

[0166] The number of RS in a CSI report may be determined according to the number of reported RS per cell and the number of cells. If the number of reported RS per cell or the number of cells is greater than 1, the NCR-MT may use differential L1-RSRP based reporting. Specifically, the NCR-MT may include the largest value of RSRP (or SINR) and a differential L1-RSRP (or SINR) in the CSI report, wherein the largest value of RSRP may be quantized to a first value, and the differential L1-RSRP may be quantized to a second value. The differential L1-RSRP value is with a reference to the largest measured RSRP.

[0167] Referring to CSI report **290** in FIG. **29**. With regard to NCR #1, the NCR-MT may include the 1.sup.st RSRP corresponding to the 1.sup.st CRI and the 2.sup.nd differential RSRP corresponding to the 2.sup.nd CRI in the CSI report **290**. The RSRP corresponding to the 2.sup.nd CRI may be determined based on the 2.sup.nd differential RSRP with reference to the 1.sup.st RSRP. For example, the RSRP corresponding to the 2.sup.nd CRI may be equal to the sum of the 1.sup.st RSRP and the 2.sup.nd differential RSRP.

[0168] In one example, the bit-width for RSRP/SINR field of the CSI report (e.g., CSI report **290**) may be equal to 7 bits. The bit-width for differential RSRP/SINR field of the CSI report may be equal to 4 bits. The number of NCR within the NCR group (e.g., the NCR group corresponding to the CSI report **290**) may be equal to 4. Total bit-width for measurement quality (i.e., total bit-width of CSI report **290**) may be equal to $(7+4)*4=44$ bits.

[0169] FIG. **30** illustrates a schematic diagram of beam reporting with NCR group based CSI compression according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with the number of reporting beams for each NCR within an NCR group. For example, two reporting beams for each NCR may be included in one CSI report. The CSI report may further include an NCR index ordering field corresponding to the NCR group. The NCR associated with the fields in the CSI report may be determined according to the NCR index ordering.

[0170] For example, assume that an NCR group includes NCR #1, NCR #2, NCR #3, and NCR #4, and the CSI report **300** corresponding to the NCR group may include a first sub-list including the 1.sup.st CRI, the 2.sup.nd CRI, the 1.sup.st RSRP, and the 2.sup.nd differential RSRP, a second sub-list including the 3.sup.rd CRI, the 4.sup.th CRI, the 3.sup.rd differential RSRP, and the 4.sup.th differential RSRP, a third sub-list including the 5.sup.th CRI, the 6.sup.th CRI, the 5.sup.th differential RSRP, and the 6.sup.th differential RSRP, and a fourth sub-list including the 7.sup.th CRI, the 8.sup.th CRI, the 7.sup.th differential RSRP, and the 8.sup.th differential RSRP. The value "00" of the NCR index ordering field represents the ordering {NCR #1, NCR #2, NCR #3, NCR #4}. The value "01" of the NCR index ordering field represents the ordering {NCR #2, NCR #1, NCR #3, NCR #4}. The value "10" of the NCR index ordering field represents the ordering {NCR #3, NCR #1, NCR #2, NCR #4}. The value "11" of the NCR index ordering field represents the ordering {NCR #4, NCR #1, NCR #2, NCR #3}. If the value of the NCR index ordering field is "01", the first sub-list, the second sub-list, the third sub-list, and the fourth sub-list of the CSI report **300** may be associated with NCR #2, NCR #1, NCR #3, and NCR #4 respectively.

[0171] In one example, the bit-width for NCR index ordering field of the CSI report may be equal $\lceil \log_2 K_{\text{sup.NCR}} \rceil = 2$, where $K_{\text{sup.NCR}}$ is the number of NCRs within the NCR group. The bit-width for RSRP/SINR field of the CSI report (e.g., CSI report **300**) may be equal to 7 bits. The bit-width for differential RSRP/SINR field of the CSI report may be equal to 4 bits. The number of NCR within the NCR group (e.g., the NCR group corresponding to the CSI report **300**) $K_{\text{sup.NCR}}$ may be equal to 4. Total bit-width for measurement quality (i.e., total bit-width of CSI report **300**) may be equal to $2+7+7*4=37$ bits.

[0172] FIG. 31 illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR reporting according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with the number of reporting beams for each NCR within an NCR group. For example, one reporting beam for one or more NCRs may be included in one CSI report. The CSI report may further include one or more differential RSRP (or SINR) for each NCR, wherein the RSRP corresponding to each NCR may be determined based on the corresponding differential RSRP with the reference to the reporting beam. The CSI report may further include an NCR index ordering field corresponding to the NCR group. The NCR associated with the fields in the CSI report may be determined according to the NCR index ordering.

[0173] For example, assume that an NCR group includes CRI/SSBRI index #1, CRI/SSBRI index #2, CRI/SSBRI index #3, and CRI/SSBRI index #4, and the CSI report 310 corresponding to the NCR group may include a first sub-list including the 1.sup.st NCR index, the 2.sup.nd NCR index, the 1.sup.st RSRP, and the 2.sup.nd differential RSRP, a second sub-list including the 3.sup.rd NCR index, the 4.sup.th NCR index, the 3.sup.rd differential RSRP, and the 4.sup.th differential RSRP, a third sub-list including the 5.sup.th NCR index, the 6.sup.th NCR index, the 5.sup.th differential RSRP, and the 6.sup.th differential RSRP, and a fourth sub-list including the 7.sup.th NCR index, the 8.sup.th NCR index, the 7.sup.th differential RSRP, and the 8.sup.th differential RSRP. The value "00" of the CRI/SSBRI index ordering field represents the ordering {CRI/SSBRI index #1, CRI/SSBRI index #2, CRI/SSBRI index #3, CRI/SSBRI index #4}. The value "01" of the CRI/SSBRI index ordering field represents the ordering {CRI/SSBRI index #2, CRI/SSBRI index #1, CRI/SSBRI index #3, CRI/SSBRI index #4}. The value "10" of the CRI/SSBRI index ordering field represents the ordering {CRI/SSBRI index #3, CRI/SSBRI index #1, CRI/SSBRI index #2, CRI/SSBRI index #4}. The value "11" of the CRI/SSBRI index ordering field represents the ordering {CRI/SSBRI index #4, CRI/SSBRI index #1, CRI/SSBRI index #2, CRI/SSBRI index #3}. If the value of the NCR index ordering field is "00", the first sub-list, the second sub-list, the third sub-list, and the fourth sub-list of the CSI report 310 may be associated with NCR #1, NCR #2, NCR #3, and NCR #4 respectively.

[0174] With regard to CRI/SSBRI index #1, the RSRP corresponding to the 2.sup.nd NCR index may be determined based on the 2.sup.nd differential RSRP with reference to the 1.sup.st RSRP. For example, the RSRP corresponding to the 2.sup.nd NCR index may be equal to the sum of the 1.sup.st RSRP and the 2.sup.nd differential RSRP. Similarly, the RSRP corresponding to the 3.sup.rd NCR index may be determined based on the 3.sup.rd differential RSRP with reference to the 1.sup.st RSRP. For example, the RSRP corresponding to the 3.sup.rd NCR index may be equal to the sum of the 1.sup.st RSRP and the 3.sup.rd differential RSRP.

[0175] With regard to the beam management schemes disclosed in FIG. 1 to FIG. 31, if none of those schemes are configured to a UE, the UE may apply the scheme disclosed in FIG. 19 as a default scheme.

[0176] Beam management for a C-link of an NCR group may be applied through more than one NCR nodes. FIG. 32 illustrates a schematic diagram of enabling simultaneous reception according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. The same indexes (e.g., SSBRI) corresponding to different NCRs within an NCR group respectively may be included in one CSI report. If the beam index is applied to a channel/RS (e.g., operation mode B as shown in FIG. 13), it is not clear that how to enable simultaneous reception. For example, if NCR 321, NCR 322, and NCR 323 report the same beam index (e.g., SSBRI of RS #n) to the gNB and the beam index is applied to a channel/RS, the gNB would not know which two NCRs (e.g., NCR 321, NCR 322, or NCR 323) should handle the C-link so as to receive the channel/RS.

[0177] FIG. 33 illustrates a schematic diagram of one beam index associated with limited multiple NCR nodes in a CSI report according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. If the same indexes (e.g., SSBRI) respectively corresponding to different NCRs are included in a CSI report, one beam index may be associated with a limited number of NCR nodes in a CSI report, wherein the limited number is less than or equal to the total number of NCR nodes within the NCR group.

The NCR group may be configured to include a number of NCR nodes in the CSI report, wherein the number of the NCR nodes may be associated with one beam index with the highest beam quality.

[0178] In one embodiment, the limited number of NCR nodes associated with one beam index may be determined based on the measurement results (e.g., RSRP). If the measurement result of a first NCR node for a specific beam index is greater than the measurement result of a second NCR node for the same beam index, the priority of associating the specific beam index with the first NCR node may be higher than the priority of associating the specific beam index with the second NCR node. For example, assume that the NCR group is allowed to associate one beam index with at most two NCR nodes in a CSI report. If NCR **331**, NCR **332**, and NCR **333** report the same SSBRI RS #n, the NCR-MT may have to select two NCR nodes from NCR **331**, NCR **332**, and NCR **333**. Since both the RSRP of RS #n measured by NCR **331** and the RSRP of RS #n measured by NCR **332** are greater than the RSRP of RS #n measured by NCR **333**, the NCR-MT may associate the SSBRI RS #n with NCR **331** and NCR **332** in the CSI report.

[0179] In one embodiment, a CSI report may include null information which means that the corresponding NCR does not select a beam index. The null information may include the highest CRI/SSBRI value, the lowest CRI/SSBRI value, or the lowest RSRP/SINR value.

[0180] FIG. **34** illustrates a schematic diagram of implicit NCR node reception based on the beam reporting according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. If the same indexes corresponding to different NCRs are included in a CSI report, the channel/RS corresponding to the beam index may be received by one or more NCRs with a predetermined rule. The NCR-MT may be configured to select N NCR nodes (where N is a positive integer greater than one) from M NCR nodes within the NCR group for C-link simultaneous reception/transmission, where M is a positive integer greater than or equal to N. The NCR-MT may select N NCR nodes with the lowest N NCR IDs (or the highest N NCR IDs, the lowest N CSI qualities, the highest N CSI qualities) from the NCR group. For example, assume that the NCR ID of NCR **341** is NCR #1, the NCR ID of NCR **342** is NCR #2, and the NCR ID of NCR **343** is NCR #3. If NCR **341**, NCR **342**, and NCR **343** report the same beam index (e.g., RS #n), NCR **341** and NCR **342** with the lowest two NCR ID (e.g., NCR #1 and NCR #2) may handle the C-link.

[0181] FIG. **35** illustrates a schematic diagram of implicit NCR node reception based on the beam reporting according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. If the same indexes corresponding to N different NCR nodes (where N is a positive integer) are included in a CSI report, the NCR-MT may be configured to use the N NCR nodes for C-link simultaneous reception/transmission. The channel/RS may be received by the NCR nodes report the same beam index. For example, assume that the NCR ID of NCR **351** is NCR #1 and the NCR ID of NCR **352** is NCR #2. If NCR **351** and NCR **352** report the same beam index (e.g., RS #n), the channel/RS may be received by both NCR **351** and NCR **352**.

[0182] FIG. **36** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR node reception by indicating NCR IDs associated with a TCI state according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. A CORESET may be activated with a TCI state or a CORESET may be associated with one or more NCRs, wherein the SS set monitoring associated with the CORESET may be received by one or more NCRs with the activated TCI state. For example, if CORESET configuration **360** received by the NCR-MT includes a CORESET ID, an NCR ID of NCR #1, an NCR ID of NCR #2, and a TCI state ID corresponding to RS #n, the SS set monitoring associated with the CORESET ID may be received by NCR #1 and NCR #2 with an activated TCI state corresponding to the TCI state ID (or RS #n).

[0183] FIG. **37** illustrates a schematic diagram of sub-lists for each NCR within a TCI state list according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. Considering few beams cover one or more NCRs, one TCI state list may include multiple sub-lists associated with multiple NCRs respectively. The number of configured TCI states associated multiple NCRs or the total number of

configured TCI states within the TCI state list may be indicated by the TCI state list, wherein the number of configured TCI states associated with multiple NCRs may be less than or equal to the total number of configured TCI states within the TCI state list. For example, the TCI state list **370** may include a sub-list for NCR #1, a sub-list for NCR #2, and a sub-list for NCR #3.

[0184] The sub-list for NCR #1 may include information associated with TCI state IDs A.sub.1, A.sub.2, . . . , A.sub.n, and may indicate that the number of the configured TCI states for NCR #1 is “n”, wherein “n” is a positive integer. The sub-list for NCR #2 may include information associated with TCS state IDs B.sub.1, B.sub.2, . . . , B.sub.m, and may indicate that the number of the configured TCI states for NCR #2 is “m”, wherein “m” is a positive integer. The sub-list for NCR #3 may include information associated with TCI state IDs C.sub.1, C.sub.2, . . . , C.sub.k, and may indicate that the number of the configured TCI states for NCR #3 is “k”, wherein “k” is a positive integer. It should be noted that $n+m+k \leq$ the maximum number of configured TCI states within the TCI state list **370**.

[0185] FIG. **38** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on a bitmap according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with a TCI state list and one or more bit streams corresponding to different NCRs respectively. The size of the TCI state list may be determined according to parameter `maxNumberConfiguredTCIstates`. The size of the bit streams may be equal to the size of the TCI state list, wherein the m-th bit stream may be associated with the m-th NCR, and the n-th configured TCI state of the TCI state list may be corresponded to the n-th bit of the bit stream. If the n-th bit of the m-th bit stream is set to “1”, the corresponding n-th configured TCI state is associated with the m-th NCR. For example, if a bit corresponding to the TCI state A.sub.1 of the bit stream **381** is set to “1”, the NCR may determine that the TCI state A.sub.1 is associated with NCR #1. If a bit corresponding to the TCI state B.sub.1 of the bit stream **382** is set to “1”, the NCR may determine that the TCI state B.sub.1 is associated with NCR #2. If a bit corresponding to the TCI state C.sub.1 of the bit stream **383** is set to “1”, the NCR may determine that the TCI state C.sub.1 is associated with NCR #3.

[0186] FIG. **39** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on a bitmap according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with a TCI state list and at least one bit stream. The size of the TCI state list may be determined according to the parameter `maxNumberConfiguredTCIstates`. The size of the bits stream may be equal to the size of the TCI state list. The n-th configured TCI state of the TCI state list may be corresponded to the n-bit of the bit stream. If the n-th bit of the bit stream is set to “1”, the corresponding n-th configured TCI state may be associated with a first NCR ID (e.g., NCR #1). If the n-th bit of the bit stream is set to “0”, the corresponding n-th configured TCI state may be associated with a second NCR ID (e.g., NCR #2). For example, since the first bit of the bit stream **390** is set to “1”, the NCR-MT may determine that the TCI state A.sub.1 corresponding to the first bit is associated with NCR #1. Since the second bit of the bit stream **390** is set to “0”, the NCR-MT may determine that the TCI state B.sub.1 corresponding to the second bit is associated with NCR #2.

[0187] FIG. **40** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on list segmentation according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with a TCI state list or a list of size for one or more NCRs. The multiple sizes in the list of size may respectively correspond to multiple NCRs (or multiple NCR IDs) in a list of NCR. For example, assume that the size of a TCI state list is N+M, where N and M are positive integers. If a list of size is configured to the NCR, and the list of size indicates that the size of TCI state list (or sub-list) of NCR #1 is equal to N, the NCR-MT may determine that the first N bits of the bit streams **400** of the TCI state list are associated with NCR #1, and the remaining M bits of the bit streams **400** are associated with NCR #2.

[0188] FIG. **41** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on list

segmentation according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with a TCI state list, a size of TCI state list for one or more NCRs, or a starting position for the one or more NCRs. For example, if the size of TCI state list for NCR #1 is equal to N and the starting position for NCR #1 is the first bit, the NCR-MT may determine that N bits of the bit stream **410** of the TCI state list are associated with NCR #1, wherein the starting position of the N bits is the first bit of the bit stream **410**. If the size of TCI state list for NCR #2 is equal to M and the starting position for NCR #2 is the (N+1)-th bit, the NCR-MT may determine that M bits of the bit stream **410** are associated with NCR #2, wherein the starting position of the M bits is the (N+1)-th bit of the bit stream **410**.

[0189] FIG. **42** illustrates a schematic diagram of sub-lists for each NCR within a TCI state list according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. Considering few beams cover one or more NCRs, one TCI state list may include one or more sub-lists associated with multiple NCRs. The number of configured TCI states associated multiple NCRs or the total number of configured TCI states within the TCI state list may be indicated by the TCI state list, wherein the number of configured TCI states associated with multiple NCRs may be less than or equal to the total number of configured TCI states within the TCI state list. For example, the TCI state list **420** may include a sub-list for both NCR #1 and NCR #2.

[0190] The sub-list for both NCR #1 and NCR #2 may include information associated with TCI state IDs A.sub.1, A.sub.2, . . . , A.sub.n, and may indicate that the number of the configured TCI states for both NCR #1 and NCR #2 is “n”, wherein “n” is a positive integer. It should be noted that $n \leq$ the maximum number of configured TCI states within the TCI state list **420**.

[0191] FIG. **43** illustrates a schematic diagram of configuring a sub-list for each NCR based on a bitmap according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with a TCI state list and one or more bit streams corresponding to different NCRs respectively. The size of the TCI state list may be determined according to parameter `maxNumberConfiguredTCIstates`. The size of the bit streams may be equal to the size of the TCI state list, wherein the m-th bit stream may be associated with the m-th NCR, and the n-th configured TCI state of the TCI state list may be corresponded to the n-th bit of the bit stream. If the n-th bit of the m-th bit stream is set to “1”, the corresponding n-th configured TCI state is associated with the m-th NCR. For example, if a bit corresponding to the TCI state A.sub.n of the bit stream **431** is set to “1”, the NCR may determine that the TCI state A.sub.n is associated with NCR #1. If a bit corresponding to the TCI state A.sub.n of the bit stream **432** is also set to “1”, the NCR may determine that the TCI state A.sub.n is also associated with NCR #2.

[0192] FIG. **44** illustrates a schematic diagram of a TCI state configured with an NCR ID according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more TCI state configurations, wherein each TCI state configuration may include a mapping relationship among a TCI state ID, a spatial QCL assumption, and an NCR ID. The NCR-MT may receive the downlink channel according to the NCR ID. For example, if the TCI state list **440** configured to the NCR-MT includes a TCI state configuration corresponding to the TCI state ID A.sub.n and the ID NCR1, the NCR-MT may receive the PDCCH through a NCR corresponding to the ID NCR1 with an activate TCI state corresponding to the TCI state ID A.sub.n (or corresponding to spatial QCL assumption RS #n). If the TCI state list **440** configured to the NCR-MT include a TCI state configuration corresponding to the TCI state ID A.sub.n' and the ID NCR2, the NCR-MT may receive the PDCCH through a NCR corresponding to the ID NCR2 with an activate TCI state corresponding to the TCI state ID A.sub.n' (or corresponding to spatial QCL assumption RS #n).

[0193] FIG. **45** illustrates a schematic diagram of a tagged TCI state list of an NCR according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more TCI state lists, wherein each TCI state list may be associated with an NCR or may be configured with an NCR. The CORESET may be activated with one or more TCI states. The CORESET may be

associated with one or more TCI state list IDs, wherein the SS set monitoring associated with the CORESET may be received by the corresponding NCR with the activated TCI state. For example, the NCR-MT may be configured with a TCI state list **451** tagged with ID NCR #1 or a TCI state list **452** tagged with ID NCR #2. The CORESET may indicate that the control resources should be applied by NCR #1 corresponding to the TCI state list ID #1 (i.e., NCR #1) with the activated TCI state A.sub.n or by NCR #2 corresponding to the TCI state list ID #2 (i.e., NCR #2) with the activated TCI state B.sub.n.

[0194] Beam management for a C-link of an NCR group may be applied through more than one NCR nodes by TDM. FIG. **46** illustrates a schematic diagram of enabling simultaneous reception according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. The same indexes (e.g., SSBRI) corresponding to different NCRs within an NCR group respectively may be included in one CSI report. If the beam index is applied to a channel/RS by TDM (e.g., operation mode C as shown in FIG. **13**), it is not clear that how to enable simultaneous reception. For example, if NCR **461**, NCR **462**, and NCR **46M** report the same beam index and NCR **461** and NCR **462** are selected to handle the C-link, the gNB would not know how to assign the 1st time resource and the 2nd time resource to NCR **461** and NCR **462**.

[0195] FIG. **47** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR reception based on a time pattern bitmap according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. A NCR-MT may be configured with a periodic resource configuration, wherein the periodic resource configuration may include a periodicity (e.g., frame, half frame, slot, slot group including one or more slots, symbol, symbol group including one or more symbols, or ns), a periodic resource identity, a symbol offset, a duration in symbols, or a beam index. The NCR-MT may further be configured with one or more bit streams. The size of the bit stream may be equal to the size of the periodicity. The m-th bit stream may be associated with the m-th time resource for the m-th NCR. The n-th time unit (e.g., slot, symbol group, or half frame) of the periodicity may be corresponded to the n-th bit of the m-th bit stream. If the n-th bit of the m-th bit stream is set to “1”, the corresponding n-th time unit may be associated with the m-th NCR. If the n-th bit of the m-th bit stream is set to “0”, the corresponding n-th time unit may not be associated with the m-th NCR. For example, if the bit corresponding the 1.sup.st slot in the bit stream **471** is set to “1”, the 1.sup.st slot may be assigned to the 1.sup.st time resource. If the bit corresponding to the N-th slot in the bit stream **472** is set to “1”, the N-th slot may be assigned to the 2.sup.nd time resource.

[0196] FIG. **48** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR reception based on a time pattern bitmap according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. If the bit corresponding to a specific slot is set to “1” in a single bit stream, the specific slot may be associated with a single NCR corresponding to the bit stream. If the bit corresponding to a specific slot is set to “1” in multiple bit streams, the specific slot may be associated with multiple NCRs respectively corresponding to the multiple bit streams. For example, if the bit corresponding to the 1.sup.st slot is set to “1” in bit stream **481** and is set to “0” in bit stream **482**, the 1.sup.st slot may be assigned only to the 1.sup.st time resource corresponding to bit stream **481**. If the bit corresponding to the 1.sup.st slot is set to “1” in both bit stream **481** and bit stream **482**, the 1.sup.st slot may be assigned to the 1.sup.st time resource corresponding to bit stream **481** and to the 2.sup.nd time resource corresponding to bit stream **482**.

[0197] FIG. **49** illustrates a schematic diagram of a time resource configuration according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR may be configured with a time resource configuration, wherein the time resource configuration may include a periodicity of time pattern of NCR node reception, a time resource ID, an NCR ID, a time offset (e.g., symbols, slots, or ns), or a duration (e.g., symbols, slots, or ns). For example, time resource configuration **490** may include a mapping relationship among time source ID 1, symbol offset O.sub.1, and duration D.sub.1 and a mapping relationship among time resource ID 2, symbol offset O.sub.2, and duration D.sub.2. Time resource #1 corresponding to time resource ID 1 may be determined according to symbol offset

O.sub.1 and duration D.sub.1, wherein the starting time of the time resource #1 may be determined according to offset O.sub.1. Time resource #2 corresponding to time resource ID 2 may be determined according to symbol offset O.sub.2 and duration D.sub.2, wherein the starting time of the time resource #2 may be determined according to offset O.sub.2.

[0198] In one embodiment, the NCR may be provided by periodicFwdRsrcSetToAddModList which is a list of sets of resources for transmissions or receptions on the access link.

[0199] In one embodiment, a set of resources, from the list of sets of resources, may be provided by NCR-PeriodicFwdResourceSet and may occur with a periodicity provided by periodicityAndOffset-r18.

[0200] In one embodiment, a resource from the set of resources may be provided by NCR-PeriodicFwdResource and may include a pair of a time resource provided by periodic TimeRsrc and a beam with an index provided by beamIndex.

[0201] In one embodiment, the time resource starts at a slot may be offset by a number of slots provided by periodicityAndOffset-r18 from the start of the period for the set of resources. The time resource starts at a symbol may be offset by symbolOffset from the start of the slot. The time resource may have a duration provided by durationInSymbols for a subcarrier spacing (SCS), wherein the SCS may be provided by referenceSCS and the cyclicPrefix of the active DL BWP.

[0202] In one embodiment, the NCR may be provided by semiPersistentFwdRsrcSetToAddModList which is a list of sets of resources for transmissions or receptions on the access link. The NCR Access Link Beam Indication MAC CE command can indicate a set of resources for the NCR to use or to stop using based on a corresponding identity provided by semiPersistentFwdRsrcSetId.

[0203] In one embodiment, the set of resources may be provided by NCR-SemiPersistentFwdResourceSet and may occur with a periodicity provided by periodicityAndOffset-r18.

[0204] In one embodiment, a resource from the set of resources may be provided by NCR-SemiPersistentFwdResource. The resource may include a pair of a time resource provided by semiPersistentTimeRsrc and a beam with an index provided by beamIndex, where beamIndex may be updated by the NCR Access Link Beam Indication MAC CE command.

[0205] In one embodiment, the time resource starts at a slot may be offset by a number of slots provided by periodicityAndOffset-r18 from the start of the period for the set of resources. The time resource starts at a symbol may be offset by symbolOffset from the start of the slot. The time resource may have a duration provided by durationInSymbols for a SCS, wherein the SCS may be provided by referenceSCS and the cyclicPrefix of the active DL BWP.

[0206] In one embodiment, the NCR does not expect overlapping time resources provided by either NCR-PeriodicFwdResourceSet or NCR-SemiPersistentFwdResourceSet to be associated with different beam indexes.

[0207] FIG. 50 illustrates a schematic diagram of determining the association between time pattern and NCR nodes according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. With regard to the operation mode C as shown in FIG. 13, if the same beam indexes (e.g., RS #n) respectively corresponding to different NCRs (e.g., NCR 501, 502, or 503) are included in a CSI report, it is not clear how to schedule time resources (e.g., time resources of RS #n) for each NCR. If different beam indexed (e.g., RS #n, RS #n+1, or RS #n+2) respectively corresponding to different NCRs (e.g., NCR 501, 502, or 503) are included in a CSI report, it is not clear how to schedule time resources (e.g., time resources of RS #n, RS #n+1, or RS #n+2) for each NCR.

[0208] FIG. 51 illustrates a schematic diagram of restricted beam reporting according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. If the same indexes (e.g., SSbRI) respectively corresponding to different NCRs are included in a CSI report, one beam index may be associated with a limited number of NCR nodes in a CSI report, wherein the limited number is less than or equal to the total number of NCR nodes within the NCR group. The NCR group may be configured to include a

number of NCR nodes in the CSI report, wherein the number of the NCR nodes may be associated with one beam index with the highest beam quality.

[0209] In one embodiment, the limited number of NCR nodes associated with one beam index may be determined based on the measurement results (e.g., RSRP). If the measurement result of a first NCR node for a specific beam index is greater than the measurement result of a second NCR node for the same beam index, the priority of associating the specific beam index with the first NCR node may be higher than the priority of associating the specific beam index with the second NCR node. For example, assume that the NCR group is allowed to associate one beam index with at most two NCR nodes in a CSI report. If NCR 511, NCR 512, and NCR 513 report the same SSBRI RS #n, the NCR-MT may have to select two NCR nodes from NCR 511, NCR 512, and NCR 513. Since both the RSRP of RS #n measured by NCR 511 and the RSRP of RS #n measured by NCR 512 are greater than the RSRP of RS #n measured by NCR 513, the NCR-MT may associate the SSBRI RS #n with NCR 511 and NCR 512 in the CSI report.

[0210] FIG. 52 illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR hopping with common TCI state according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR group may be configured with a time resource configuration, wherein the time resource configuration may indicate one or more time resources in time domain. If a channel/RS could be received by M NCR nodes (where M is a positive integer greater than 1), the channel/RS received by the m-th lowest NCR ID may apply the m-th time resource in time domain, the channel/RS received by the m-th highest NCR ID may apply the m-th time resource in time domain, the channel/RS received by the NCR of the m-th lowest CSI quality may apply the m-th time resource in time domain, or the channel/RS received by the NCR of the m-th highest CSI quality may apply the m-th time resource in time domain, wherein $1 \leq m \leq M$. For example, assume that a channel/RS could be received by 2 NCR nodes. The channel/RS received by NCR 521 with the lowest ID NCR #1 may apply the 1.sup.st time resource, and the channel/RS received by NCR 522 with the second lowest ID NCR #2 may apply the 2.sup.nd time resource.

[0211] FIG. 53 illustrates a schematic diagram of implicit NCR node reception according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. If the same indexes corresponding to different NCRs are included in a CSI report, the channel/RS corresponding to the beam index may be received by one or more NCRs according to one or more configured time resources. The NCR-MT may be configured to select N NCR nodes (where N is a positive integer greater than one) from M NCR nodes within the NCR group for C-link simultaneous reception/transmission, where M is a positive integer greater than or equal to N. The channel/RS received by the m-th lowest NCR ID may apply the m-th time resource in time domain, the channel/RS received by the m-th highest NCR ID may apply the m-th time resource in time domain, the channel/RS received by the NCR of the m-th lowest CSI quality may apply the m-th time resource in time domain, or the channel/RS received by the NCR of the m-th highest CSI quality may apply the m-th time resource in time domain, wherein $1 \leq m \leq M$.

[0212] For example, assume that the NCR ID of NCR 531 is NCR #1, the NCR ID of NCR 532 is NCR #2, and the NCR ID of NCR 533 is NCR #3. If NCR 531, NCR 532, and NCR 533 report the same beam index (e.g., RS #n), NCR 531 and NCR 532 with the lowest two NCR ID (e.g., NCR #1 and NCR #2) may handle the C-link. The channel/RS received by NCR 531 with the lowest NCR ID (i.e., NCR #1) may apply the 1.sup.st time resource and the channel/RS received by NCR 532 with the second lowest NCR ID (i.e., NCR #2) may apply the 2.sup.nd time resource.

[0213] FIG. 54 illustrates a schematic diagram of indicating NCR IDs associated with a TCI state according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. Assume that the same beam indexes (e.g., RS #n) respectively corresponding to different NCRs are included in a CSI report. If the beam index is applied to a channel/RS, the channel/RS received by the m-th NCR (e.g., NCR with the m-th lowest NCR ID or NCR with the m-th highest NCR ID) may apply the m-th time resource in time domain, wherein the channel/RS may be indicated/activated/configured with a TCI state. The

TCI state may be associated with one or more NCR IDs. For example, if CORESET configuration **540** received by the NCR-MT includes a CORESET ID, an NCR ID of NCR #1, an NCR ID of NCR #2, and a TCI state ID corresponding to RS #n, the SS set monitoring associated with the CORESET ID may be received by NCR #1 and NCR #2 with an activated TCI state corresponding to the TCI state ID (or RS #n), wherein the 1st time resource may be assigned to NCR #1 with the lowest NCR ID and the 2nd time resource may be assigned to NCR #2 with the second lowest NCR ID.

[0214] FIG. **55** illustrates a schematic diagram of sub-lists for each NCR within a TCI state list according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. Considering few beams cover one or more NCRs, one TCI state list may include multiple sub-lists associated with multiple NCRs respectively. The number of configured TCI states associated multiple NCRs or the total number of configured TCI states within the TCI state list may be indicated by the TCI state list, wherein the number of configured TCI states associated with multiple NCRs may be less than or equal to the total number of configured TCI states within the TCI state list. For example, the TCI state list **550** may include a sub-list for NCR #1, a sub-list for NCR #2, and a sub-list for NCR #3.

[0215] The sub-list for NCR #1 may include information associated with TCI state IDs A.sub.1, A.sub.2, . . . , A.sub.n, and may indicate that the number of the configured TCI states for NCR #1 is “n”, wherein “n” is a positive integer. The sub-list for NCR #2 may include information associated with TCI state IDs B.sub.1, B.sub.2, . . . , B.sub.m, and may indicate that the number of the configured TCI states for NCR #2 is “m”, wherein “m” is a positive integer. The sub-list for NCR #3 may include information associated with TCI state IDs C.sub.1, C.sub.2, . . . , C.sub.k, and may indicate that the number of the configured TCI states for NCR #3 is “k”, wherein “k” is a positive integer. It should be noted that $n+m+k \leq$ the maximum number of configured TCI states within the TCI state list **550**.

[0216] FIG. **56** illustrates a schematic diagram of sub-lists for each NCR within a TCI state list according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. A CORESET may be activated with one or more TCI states or be configured with one or more TCI states. The m-th activated/configured TCI state may be associated with the m-th time resource. For example, if CORESET configuration **560** received by the NCR-MT includes a CORESET ID, a TCI state ID corresponding to TCI state A.sub.n for RS #n, and a TCI state ID corresponding to TCI state B.sub.n for RS #n, the 1.sup.st time resource of RS #n may apply the TCI state A.sub.n, and the 2.sup.nd time resource of RS #n may apply the TCI state B.sub.n.

[0217] FIG. **57** illustrates a schematic diagram of a TCI state configured with an NCR ID according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more TCI state configurations, wherein each TCI state configuration may include a mapping relationship among a TCI state ID, a spatial QCL assumption, and an NCR ID. The NCR-MT may receive the downlink channel according to the NCR ID. For example, if the TCI state list **571** configured to the NCR-MT includes a TCI state configuration corresponding to the TCI state ID A.sub.n and the ID NCR1, the NCR-MT may receive the PDCCH through a NCR corresponding to the ID NCR1 with an activated TCI state corresponding to the TCI state ID A.sub.n (or corresponding to spatial QCL assumption RS #n). If the TCI state list **571** configured to the NCR-MT includes a TCI state configuration corresponding to the TCI state ID A.sub.n' and the ID NCR2, the NCR-MT may receive the PDCCH through a NCR corresponding to the ID NCR2 with an activated TCI state corresponding to the TCI state ID A.sub.n' (or corresponding to spatial QCL assumption RS #n).

[0218] A CORESET may be activated with one or more TCI states or be configured with one or more TCI states. The m-th activated/configured TCI state may be associated with the m-th time resource. For example, if CORESET configuration **572** received by the NCR-MT includes a CORESET ID, a TCI state ID corresponding to TCI state A.sub.n for RS #n, and a TCI state ID corresponding to TCI state A.sub.n' for RS #n, the 1.sup.st time resource of RS #n for NCR1 may

apply the TCI state A.sub.n, and the 2.sup.nd time resource of RS #n for NCR2 may apply the TCI state A.sub.n'.

[0219] FIG. **58** illustrates a schematic diagram of a tagged TCI state list of an NCR according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more TCI state lists, wherein each TCI state list may be associated with an NCR or may be configured with an NCR. The CORESET may be activated with one or more TCI states. The CORESET may be associated with one or more TCI state list IDs, wherein the SS set monitoring associated with the CORESET may be received by the corresponding NCR with the activated TCI state, and the m-th TCI state list may be associated with the m-th time resource.

[0220] For example, the NCR-MT may be configured with a TCI state list **581** tagged with ID NCR #1 or a TCI state list **582** tagged with ID NCR #2. The CORESET may indicate that the control resources should be applied by NCR #1 corresponding to the TCI state list ID #1 (i.e., NCR #1) with the activated TCI state A.sub.n and by NCR #2 corresponding to the TCI state list ID #2 (i.e., NCR #2) with the activated TCI state A.sub.n by TDM, wherein the 1.sup.st time resource may be assigned to NCR #1 corresponding to TCI state list **581** and the 2.sup.nd time resource may be assigned to NCR #2 corresponding to TCI state list **582**.

[0221] FIG. **59** illustrates a schematic diagram of determining the association between time pattern and NCR nodes according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. With regard to the operation mode C as shown in FIG. **13**, if different beam indexes (e.g., RS #n, RS #n+1, or RS #n+2) respectively corresponding to different NCRs (e.g., NCR **591**, **592**, or **593**) are included in a CSI report, it is not clear how to schedule time resources (e.g., time resources of RS #n, RS #n+1, or RS #n+2) for each NCR.

[0222] FIG. **60** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR hopping with multiple TCI states according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. One CORESET may be activated with more than one TCI state. Assume that different beam indexes respectively corresponding to different NCRs are included in a CSI report. If more than one beam index is applied to a channel/RS, the channel/RS may be indicated/activated/configured with more than one TCI state, wherein each TCI state may be associated with one or more NCR IDs. One CORESET may be configured/activated with N TCI states, where N is a positive integer and one of N TCI states may map to one NCR. The m-th activated/configured TCI state may be associated with the m-th time resource. The channel/RS may be received by those NCRs according to the pre-configured time pattern.

[0223] For example, assume that beam index RS #n for NCR #1, beam index RS #n+1 for NCR #2, and beam index RS #n+2 for NCR #3 are included in CSI report **600**. If a CORESET is activated/configured with two TCI states including TCI state #A.sub.n corresponding to RS #n and TCI state #A.sub.n+1 corresponding to RS #n+1, the 1.sup.st time resource may be assigned to RS #n corresponding to the activated TCI state #A.sub.n and the 2.sup.nd time resource may be assigned to RS #n+1 corresponding to the activated TCI state #A.sub.n+1.

[0224] FIG. **61** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR hopping with multiple TCI states according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. One CORESET may be activated with more than one TCI state. Assume that different beam indexes respectively corresponding to different NCRs are included in a CSI report. If more than one beam index is applied to a channel/RS, the channel/RS may be indicated/activated/configured with more than one TCI state, wherein each TCI state may be associated with one or more NCR IDs. One CORESET may be configured/activated with a TCI state, where the TCI state may map to one NCR. The CORESET may be configured/associated with one of configured time resources. The channel/RS may be received by those NCRs according to the pre-configured time pattern.

[0225] For example, assume that beam index RS #n for NCR #1, beam index RS #n+1 for NCR #2, and beam index RS #n+2 for NCR #3 are included in CSI report **610**. If CORESET #1 is activated/configured with TCI state #A.sub.n corresponding to RS #n and CORESET #2 is activated/configured with TCI state #A.sub.n+1 corresponding to RS #n+1, the 1.sup.st time

resource may be assigned to RS #n corresponding to the activated TCI state #A.sub.n and CORESET #1 and the 2.sup.nd time resource may be assigned to RS #n+1 corresponding to the activated TCI state #A.sub.n+1 and CORESET #2.

[0226] FIG. **62** illustrates a schematic diagram of SS set monitoring according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. One CORESET may be activated with one TCI state. One SS set may be associated with more than one CORESET. An NCR-MT may be configured with a SS set, wherein the SS set maybe configured with more than one CORESET. The SS set monitoring associated with the CORESET may be received by the corresponding NCR with the activated TCI state. For example, assume that CORESET #1 is configured with TCI state #A.sub.n for RS #n, CORESET #2 is configured with TCI state #A.sub.n+1 for RS #n+1, and CORESET #1 and CORESET #2 are configured to SS set **620** (i.e., SS set #B). The SS set monitoring associated with CORESET #1 may be received by the NCR corresponding to the activated TCI state #A.sub.n, and the SS set monitoring associated with CORESET #2 may be received by the NCR corresponding to the activated TCI state #A.sub.n+1, wherein the 1.sup.st time resource may be assigned to the TCI state #A.sub.n and the 2.sup.nd time resource may be assigned to the TCI state #A.sub.n+1.

[0227] FIG. **63** illustrates a schematic diagram of SS set monitoring according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. One CORESET may be activated with one TCI state. Each SS set associated with the CORESET may be linked to a TCI state according to a time pattern. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more SS sets, wherein each SS set maybe linked with each other by configuration. The two linked SS sets may be the same SS set type (USS/CSS), the same DCI format to monitor, or the same number of candidates for each AL. The SS set monitoring associated with the CORESET may be received by the corresponding NCR with the activated TCI state.

[0228] For example, assume that CORESET #1 is configured with TCI state #A.sub.n for RS #n and is configured to SS set **631** (i.e., SS set #A), and CORESET #2 is configured with TCI state #A.sub.n+1 for RS #n+1 and is configured to SS set **632** (i.e., SS set #B). The SS set monitoring of SS set #A associated with CORESET #1 may be received by the NCR corresponding to the activated TCI state #A.sub.n, and the SS set monitoring of SS set #B associated with CORESET #2 may be received by the NCR corresponding to the activated TCI state #A.sub.n+1, wherein the 1.sup.st time resource may be assigned to the TCI state #A.sub.n and the 2.sup.nd time resource may be assigned to the TCI state #A.sub.n+1.

[0229] FIG. **64** illustrates a schematic diagram of CORESET group monitoring according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. One CORESET may be activated with one TCI state. Once CORESET group may be configured with one or more CORESETs. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more CORESETs, wherein each CORESET may be configured with a CORESET group ID. The CORESET group ID may be configured with a time resource ID. The channel/RS may be received by hosed NCRs according to a pre-determined time pattern.

[0230] For example, assume that beam indexes RS #n and RS #m reported by NCR #1 and beam indexed RS #n+1 and RS #m+1 reported by NCR #2 are included in CSI report **640**, wherein CORESET #1 and CORESET #3 are configured to CORESET group #1, and CORESET #2 and CORESET #4 are configured to CORESET group #2. The 1.sup.st time resource may be assigned to CORESET group #1, wherein TCI state #A.sub.n may be applied for the 1.sup.st time resource and TCI state #A.sub.n+1 may be applied for the 2.sup.nd time resource.

[0231] FIG. **65** illustrates a schematic diagram of capability of NCR according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR may report one or more capabilities to the gNB, wherein the capabilities may include Capability 0, Capability 1, Capability 2, and Capability 3. The reporting of Capability 0 represents that the NCR may be operated in operation mode A (i.e., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **651**). The reporting of Capability 1 represents that the NCR may be switched between operation mode A and operation mode B (i.e., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **652**). The reporting of

Capability 2 represents that the NCR may be switched between operation mode A and operation mode C (i.e., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **653**). The reporting of Capability 3 represents that the NCR may be switched among operation mode A, operation mode B, and operation mode C.

[0232] In one embodiment, an NCR may be configured with one or more configurations of operation modes according to the capability of the NCR.

[0233] In one embodiment, an NCR may be configured/activated/indicated with one or more configuration of operation modes by RRC, MAC CE, or DCI.

[0234] In one embodiment, an NCR may be predetermined/configured with a default operation mode (or a default time resource configuration), for example, operation mode A.

[0235] If an NCR is not configured/activated/indicated with one or more configurations of operation modes, the NCR may apply the default OM for the C-link to communicate with gNB.

[0236] FIG. **66** illustrates a schematic diagram of operation mode switching according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. For example, an NCR supporting Capability 3 may be switched between operation mode A (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **661**) and one of operation mode B (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **662**) and operation mode C (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **663**) based on an RRC message. Furthermore, the NCR may be switched between operation B and operation C based on a MAC CE.

[0237] FIG. **67** illustrates a schematic diagram of operation mode switching according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR may be switched between operation mode A (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **671**) and operation mode D (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **672**) based on a MAC CE. When operation mode D is applied by an NCR group, the NCR group may access the C-link through more than one NCR node simultaneously. Furthermore, the NCR group may access the C-link through more than one NCR node by TDM. For example, NCR #1 and NCR #2 may perform control signaling transmission simultaneously. In addition, NCR #1 and NCR #3 may perform control signaling transmission simultaneously. Furthermore, NCR #2 and NCR #3 may perform control signaling transmission by TDM, as shown in control signaling transmission timeline **672**.

[0238] FIG. **68** illustrates a schematic diagram of a scheme of restricted beam reporting for NCR-MT with Capability 1 (e.g., capability to switch between operation modes A and B) according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more NCR nodes associated with one beam index in a CSI report. The NCR-MT may determine the number of NCR nodes associated with one beam index in the CSI report. If the number of NCR nodes associated with one beam index in the CSI report is equal to one, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode A (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **681**). If the number of NCR nodes associated with one beam index in the CSI report is greater than one, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode B (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **682**).

[0239] FIG. **69** illustrates a schematic diagram of a scheme of restricted beam reporting for NCR-MT with Capability 3 (e.g., capability to switch among operation modes A, B, and C) according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more NCR nodes associated with one beam index in a CSI report. The NCR-MT may determine the number of NCR nodes associated with one beam index in the CSI report. If the number of NCR nodes associated with one beam index in the CSI report is equal to one, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode A (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **691**). If the number of NCR nodes associated with one beam index in the CSI report is greater than one, the NCR-MT may determine whether a time pattern for TDM based NCR

reception is configured to the NCR-MT. If the time pattern is not configured to the NCR-MT, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode B (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **692**). If the time pattern is configured to the NCR-MT, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode C (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **693**).

[0240] FIG. **70** illustrates a schematic diagram of a scheme of restricted beam reporting for NCR-MT with Capability 2 (e.g., capability to switch between operation modes A and C) according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more NCR nodes associated with one beam index in a CSI report. The NCR-MT may determine the number of NCR nodes associated with one beam index in the CSI report. If the number of NCR nodes associated with one beam index in the CSI report is equal to one, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode A (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **701**). If the number of NCR nodes associated with one beam index in the CSI report is greater than one, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode C (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **702**).

[0241] FIG. **71** illustrates a schematic diagram of a scheme of implicit NCR node reception for NCR-MT with Capability 1 (e.g., capability to switch between operation modes A and B) according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more default NCR nodes for C-link transmission/reception. The NCR-MT may determine the number of NCR node IDs (e.g., the N lowest NCR node IDs where N is a positive integer) configured as default NCR nodes for C-link transmission/reception. If the number of NCR node IDs is equal to one, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode A (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **711**). If the number of NCR node IDs is greater than one, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode B (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **712**).

[0242] FIG. **72** illustrates a schematic diagram of a scheme of implicit NCR node reception for NCR-MT with Capability 3 (e.g., capability to switch among operation modes A, B, and C) according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more default NCR nodes for C-link transmission/reception. The NCR-MT may determine the number of NCR node IDs (e.g., the N lowest NCR node IDs where N is a positive integer) configured as default NCR nodes for C-link transmission/reception. If the number of NCR node IDs is equal to one, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode A (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **721**). If the number of NCR node IDs is greater than one, the NCR-MT may determine whether a time pattern for TDM based NCR reception is configured to the NCR-MT. If the time pattern is not configured to the NCR-MT, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode B (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **722**). If the time pattern is configured to the NCR-MT, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode C (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **723**).

[0243] FIG. **73** illustrates a schematic diagram of a scheme of implicit NCR node reception for NCR-MT with Capability 2 (e.g., capability to switch among operation modes A and C) according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more default NCR nodes for C-link transmission/reception. The NCR-MT may determine the number of NCR node IDs (e.g., the N lowest NCR node IDs where N is a positive integer) configured as default NCR nodes for C-link transmission/reception. If the number of NCR node IDs is equal to one, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode A (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **731**). If the number of NCR node IDs is greater than one, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode C (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **732**).

[0244] FIG. **74** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR node reception based on NCR ID for NCR-

MT with Capability 1 (e.g., capability to switch among operation modes A and B) according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more NCR nodes corresponding to a TCI state and/or TCI state list. The NCR-MT may determine the number of NCR nodes corresponding to a TCI state and/or a TCI state list according to one or more higher layer configurations. If the number of NCR nodes corresponding to a TCI state and/or a TCI state list is equal to one, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode A (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **741**). If the number of NCR nodes corresponding to a TCI state and/or a TCI state list is greater than one, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode B (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **742**).

[0245] FIG. **75** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR node reception based on NCR ID for NCR-MT with Capability 3 (e.g., capability to switch among operation modes A, B, and C) according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more NCR nodes corresponding to a TCI state and/or TCI state list. The NCR-MT may determine the number of NCR nodes corresponding to a TCI state and/or a TCI state list according to one or more higher layer configurations. If the number of NCR nodes corresponding to a TCI state and/or a TCI state list is equal to one, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode A (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **751**). If the number of NCR node IDs is greater than one, the NCR-MT may determine whether a time pattern for TDM based NCR reception is configured to the NCR-MT. If the time pattern is not configured to the NCR-MT, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode B (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **752**). If the time pattern is configured to the NCR-MT, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode C (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **753**).

[0246] FIG. **76** illustrates a schematic diagram of NCR node reception based on NCR ID for NCR-MT with Capability 2 (e.g., capability to switch among operation modes A and C) according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR-MT may be configured with one or more NCR nodes corresponding to a TCI state and/or TCI state list. The NCR-MT may determine the number of NCR nodes corresponding to a TCI state and/or a TCI state list according to one or more higher layer configurations. If the number of NCR nodes corresponding to a TCI state and/or a TCI state list is equal to one, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode A (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **761**). If the number of NCR nodes corresponding to a TCI state and/or a TCI state list is greater than one, the NCR-MT may apply operation mode C (e.g., the operation mode corresponding to control signaling transmission timeline **762**).

[0247] FIG. **77** illustrates a schematic diagram of time resource configurations according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. An NCR may be configured with one or more time resource configurations. The 1.sup.st time resource configuration **771** corresponding to the first OM (e.g., operation mode A) may be configured to the NCR for power saving purpose. The 1.sup.st time resource configuration **771** may include a mapping relationship among time source ID 1, symbol offset O.sub.1, and duration D.sub.1. Time resource #1 corresponding to time resource ID 1 may be determined according to symbol offset O.sub.1 and duration D.sub.1, wherein the starting time of the time resource #1 may be determined according to offset O.sub.1.

[0248] The 2.sup.nd time resource configuration **772** corresponding to the second OM (e.g., operation mode B) may be configured to the NCR for improving reliability/diversity gain. The 2.sup.nd time resource configuration **772** may include a mapping relationship among time source ID 1, symbol offset O.sub.1, and duration D.sub.1 and a mapping relationship among time resource ID 2, symbol offset O.sub.2, and duration D.sub.2. Time resource #1 corresponding to time resource ID 1 may be determined according to symbol offset O.sub.1 and duration D.sub.1, wherein the starting time of the time resource #1 may be determined according to offset O.sub.1. Time resource

#2 corresponding to time resource ID 2 may be determined according to symbol offset O.sub.2 and duration D.sub.2, wherein the starting time of the time resource #2 may be determined according to offset O.sub.2. NCR #1 and NCR #2 may respectively access time resource #1 and time resource #2 simultaneously.

[0249] The 3.sup.rd time resource configuration **773** corresponding to the third OM (e.g., operation mode C) may be configured to the NCR for improving robustness. The 3.sup.rd time resource configuration **773** may include a mapping relationship among time source ID 1, symbol offset O.sub.1, and duration D.sub.1 and a mapping relationship among time resource ID 2, symbol offset O.sub.2, and duration D.sub.2. Time resource #1 corresponding to time resource ID 1 may be determined according to symbol offset O.sub.1 and duration D.sub.1, wherein the starting time of the time resource #1 may be determined according to offset O.sub.1. Time resource #2 corresponding to time resource ID 2 may be determined according to symbol offset O.sub.2 and duration D.sub.2, wherein the starting time of the time resource #2 may be determined according to offset O.sub.2. NCR #1 and NCR #2 may respectively access time resource #1 and time resource #2 by TDM.

[0250] In one embodiment, an NCR may be predetermined/configured with a default OM (or a default time resource configuration) such as operation mode A. If the NCR is not configured/activated/indicated with one of at least one time resource configuration, the NCR may apply the default OM for the C-link to communication with gNB.

[0251] FIG. **78** illustrates a flowchart of a method of beam management according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. The method may be adapted to a communication device (e.g., UE or NCR-MT) including an entity and a function, wherein the entity communicates with a network via a first link, and the function forwards signals via a second link, wherein the first link is associated with a first transmission configuration indicator (TCI) state. In step **S781**, receiving, by the entity, a channel state information (CSI) reporting configuration. In step **S782**, transmitting, by the entity, a CSI report according to the CSI reporting configuration. In step **S783**, receiving, by the entity, a TCI state list configuration.

[0252] FIG. **79** illustrates a flowchart of a method of beam management according to one embodiment of the present disclosure. The method may be adapted to a communication device (e.g., base station or gNB). In step **S791**, transmitting a channel state information (CSI) reporting configuration. In step **S792**, receiving a CSI report according to the CSI reporting configuration. In step **S793**, transmitting a transmission configuration indicator (TCI) state list configuration.

[0253] FIG. **80** illustrates a schematic diagram of a communication device **800** according to one embodiment of the present disclosure, wherein the communication device **800** may be an NCR, NCR group, UE, cell TRP, gNB, or panel, as mentioned in the above embodiments, but not limited herein. The communication device **800** may include a processor **801**, a storage medium **802**, and a transceiver **803**. The processor **801** is coupled to the storage medium **802** and the transceiver **803** and is configured to access and execute a plurality of modules stored in the storage medium **802**.

[0254] The processor **801** could be implemented by using programmable units such as a micro-processor, a micro-controller, a DSP chip, a field programmable gate array (FPGA), and so forth.

[0255] The storage medium **802** may be, for example, any type of fixed or removable random access memory (RAM), a read-only memory (ROM), a flash memory, a hard disk drive (HDD), a solid state drive (SSD) or similar element, or a combination thereof, configured to record a plurality of modules or various applications executable by the processor **801**. In one embodiment, the plurality of modules may include an NCR-MT entity or an NCR-Fwd entity.

[0256] The transceiver **803** may be configured to transmit or receive signals. The transceiver **803** may also perform operations such as low noise amplifying, impedance matching, frequency mixing, up or down frequency conversion, filtering, amplifying, and so forth. The transceiver **803** may include one or more digital-to-analog (D/A) converters or analog-to-digital (A/D) converters which are configured to convert from an analog signal format to a digital signal format during

uplink signal processing and from a digital signal format to an analog signal format during downlink signal processing.

[0257] In summary, the present disclosure provides a method for enabling cooperation among multiple NCRs. For an NCR group, the number of NCR-MTs used to communicate with the gNB can be reduced. As a result, control signaling overhead may be decreased, UL resource scheduling (e.g., co-scheduled with normal UEs) may become more flexible, power consumption for C-link operations may be reduced, and greater flexibility in BH-link operations (e.g., the BH-link is not required to cooperate with the C-link) may be achieved.

[0258] It will be apparent to those skilled in the art that various modifications and variations can be made to the disclosed embodiments without departing from the scope or spirit of the disclosure. In view of the foregoing, it is intended that the disclosure covers modifications and variations provided that they fall within the scope of the following claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A communication device comprises an entity and a function, wherein the entity communicates with a network via a first link, and the function forwards signals via a second link, wherein the first link is associated with a first transmission configuration indicator (TCI) state, wherein the entity is configured to perform: receiving a channel state information (CSI) reporting configuration; transmitting a CSI report according to the CSI reporting configuration; and receiving a TCI state list configuration.
2. The communication device of claim 1, wherein the CSI reporting configuration comprises a reference signal list.
3. The communication device of claim 1, wherein the CSI report comprises at least one of the following: an identification of reference signal, a reference signal received power (RSRP) value corresponding to the reference signal, or a signal to noise ratio value corresponding to the reference signal.
4. The communication device of claim 1, wherein a TCI state in the TCI state list configuration comprises a parameter for configuring a quasi co-location relationship between a downlink reference signal and a demodulation reference signal (DM-RS) port, wherein the DM-RS port is corresponded to at least one of a physical downlink shared channel (PDSCH), a physical downlink control channel (PDCCH), or a channel state information reference signal (CSI-RS) port of a CSI-RS resource.
5. The communication device of claim 1, wherein the communication device is configured to: performing a reception via the second link according to a quasi co-location relationship, wherein the quasi co-location relationship is determined according to a TCI state, wherein the TCI state is comprised in a downlink beam indication in a medium access control control element (MAC CE).
6. The communication device of claim 1, wherein the communication device is configured to: performing a reception via the first link and the second link simultaneously in a set of symbols, wherein a second TCI state for a reception via the second link is the same as a first TCI state for a reception via the first link.
7. The communication device of claim 1, wherein the communication device is configured to: performing a transmission via the first link and the second link simultaneously in a set of symbols, wherein a first spatial filter for a transmission via the first link is the same as a second spatial filter for a transmission via the second link.
8. The communication device of claim 1, wherein the communication device is configured to: performing a reception via the first link in a first set of symbols and via the second link in a second set of symbols respectively, wherein the second set of symbols is different from the first set of symbols.
9. The communication device of claim 8, wherein a reception via the second link is performed

based on a quasi co-location relationship, wherein the quasi co-location relationship is determined according to a TCI state.

10. The communication device of claim 1, wherein the communication device is configured to: performing a transmission via the first link in a first set of symbols and via the second link in a second set of symbols respectively, wherein the second set of symbols is different from the first set of symbols.

11. The communication device of claim 10, wherein a transmission via the second link is performed by using a spatial filter corresponding to a unified TCI state.

12. The communication device of claim 1, wherein the communication device is configured to: accessing a network as a repeater; and transmitting a repeater related information to a serving base station.

13. The communication device of claim 1, wherein the communication device is configured to: receiving a periodic resource configuration, wherein the periodic resource configuration comprises the following: a periodicity, a periodic resource identity, a symbol offset, a duration in symbols, or a beam index.

14. The communication device of claim 1, wherein the CSI report comprises at least one identification of at least one reference signal, wherein a number of the at least one reference signal is determined according to a number of reported reference signals per cell and a number of cells.

15. The communication device of claim 14, wherein the communication device is configured to perform: in response to at least one of the number of reported reference signals per cell and the number of cells being greater than one, including a differential reference signal received power (RSRP) in the CSI report.

16. The communication device of claim 15, wherein the CSI report further comprises a largest measured RSRP, wherein the largest measured RSRP is quantized to a first value and the differential RSRP is quantized to a second value.

17. The communication device of claim 15, wherein the CSI report further comprises a largest measured RSRP, wherein the differential RSRP is with a reference to the largest measured RSRP.

18. A method of beam management, adapted to a communication device comprising an entity and a function, wherein the entity communicates with a network via a first link, and the function forwards signals via a second link, wherein the first link is associated with a first transmission configuration indicator (TCI) state, and the method comprises: receiving, by the entity, a channel state information (CSI) reporting configuration; transmitting, by the entity, a CSI report according to the CSI reporting configuration; and receiving, by the entity, a TCI state list configuration.

19. A communication device, comprising: a transceiver; and a processor, coupled to the transceiver, wherein the processor is configured to perform: transmitting a channel state information (CSI) reporting configuration; receiving a CSI report according to the CSI reporting configuration; and transmitting a transmission configuration indicator (TCI) state list configuration.

20. A method of beam management, adapted to a communication device, wherein the method comprises: transmitting a channel state information (CSI) reporting configuration; receiving a CSI report according to the CSI reporting configuration; and transmitting a transmission configuration indicator (TCI) state list configuration.
